

वेद

Rigvedic & Vedic Literature

ऋग्वैदिक काल एवं वैदिक साहित्य | UPSC/SSC/PSC

EN हिंदी Both



UPDATED JULY 2026 | UPSC PRELIMS + MAINS + SSC

ऋग्वैदिक एवं उत्तर वैदिक काल + सम्पूर्ण वैदिक साहित्य

Rigvedic & Later Vedic Period + Vedas, Upavedas, Vedangas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads

1500–600 BCE

Early 1500–1000, Later 1000–600 BCE

4 Vedas + 4 Upavedas + 6 Vedangas

Complete Literature

Sapta Sindhu

7 Rivers – Core Region

By Vipulendra Tripathi Sir

UPSC/SSC Special

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1. परिचय / Introduction to Vedic Period

ENGLISH

Vedic Period 1500–600 BCE – Named after Vedas (source of knowledge). After decline of Indus Valley ~1900 BCE, Indo-Aryans migrated from Central Asia (Steppe) – but now Rakhigarhi DNA 2019 shows continuity, debate ongoing. Max Muller said Aryans came 1500 BCE, but new ASI findings push to 2000 BCE.

Early Vedic / Rigvedic: 1500–1000 BCE – Sapta Sindhu region (7 rivers), Pastoral economy, tribe called Jana, chief Rajan.

Later Vedic: 1000–600 BCE – Shift to Gangetic plain (Kurukshetra, Videha), agriculture dominant, Janapadas formed, caste rigid.

हिंदी

वैदिक काल 1500–600 ईसा पूर्व – वेदों के नाम पर। सिंधु सभ्यता के पतन के बाद आर्यों का आगमन। मैक्स मूलर ने 1500 ईसा पूर्व कहा, पर नए शोध 2000 ईसा पूर्व बताते हैं। राखीगढ़ी DNA 2019 में निरंतरता मिली।

ऋग्वैदिक: 1500–1000 – सप्त सिंधु क्षेत्र, पशुपालन प्रधान, जनजाति – जन, मुखिया – राजन।

उत्तर वैदिक: 1000–600 – गंगा-यमुना दोआब में विस्तार, कृषि प्रधान, जनपद बने, वर्ण कठोर।

Latest Debate July 2026:

UPSC now asks Vedic period as 1500–600 BCE but also mentions indigenous origin theory due to Sinauli chariot 2000 BCE, Rakhigarhi DNA, Bhirrana 7500 BCE continuity – question framed as 'Aryan migration vs continuity'.

UPSC अब वैदिक काल को 1500–600 मानता है पर साथ ही सिनौली रथ 2000 ईसा पूर्व, राखीगढ़ी DNA से स्वदेशी निरंतरता सिद्धांत भी पूछता है।

2. सप्त सिंधु क्षेत्र मानचित्र / Sapta Sindhu Map



7 Rivers / सप्त सिंधु:

1. Sindhu (Indus) – सिंधु
2. Vitasta (Jhelum) – वितस्ता
3. Asikni (Chenab) – अस्किनी
4. Parushni (Ravi) – परुष्णी
5. Vipasa (Beas) – विपासा

6. Shutudri (Sutlej) – शुतुद्री

7. Saraswati (Ghaggar-Hakra) – सरस्वती (most sacred, Naditama)

Key Terms:

Bharata Tribe: King Sudas, won Battle of Ten Kings (Dasarajna Yudha) on Parushni Ravi

Tritsu vs Bharata etc.

Brahmavarta: Between Saraswati & Drishadvati

Aryavarta: Between Himalaya & Vindhya, East to West sea

Battle of Ten Kings / दशराज युद्ध:

Rigveda Book 7, Sudas (Bharata) vs 10 tribes coalition (5 Aryans + 5 non-Aryans) – Purus, Yadus, Turvasas, Anus, Druhyus + Alinas, Pakthas, Bhalanas, Sivas, Vishanins. Won by Bharata – Bharat name from this.

3. ऋग्वैदिक vs उत्तर वैदिक / Rigvedic vs Later Vedic – UPSC Most Imp Comparison

Aspect / पहलू	Rigvedic 1500–1000 BCE	Later Vedic 1000–600 BCE
Geography / भूगोल	Sapta Sindhu (Punjab, Haryana) सप्त सिंधु (पंजाब, हरियाणा)	Ganga-Yamuna doab, Kurukshetra, Videha, Magadha गंगा-यमुना दोआब, कुरुक्षेत्र, विदेह, मगध
Economy / अर्थव्यवस्था	Pastoral, cattle main wealth (Gavishthi, Gomat), barley (Yava) पशुपालन, गाय मुख्य धन, जौ	Agriculture dominant, wheat, rice (Vrihi), iron plough (Krishna- ayas) कृषि प्रधान, गेहूं, चावल, लोहे का हल
Polity / राजनीति	Tribal, Jana, Rajan, Sabha Samiti Vidatha, no Janapada	Janapada, King more powerful, Sabha Samiti decline, Vidatha disappeared, Mahajanapadas seed
Society / समाज	Flexible Varna based on work, no child marriage, Sati no, women like Lopamudra, Ghosha, Apala, Vishwavara rishikas, monogamy mostly लचीला वर्ण कर्म आधारित, बाल विवाह नहीं, सती नहीं, विदुषी महिलाएं	Varna rigid birth based, 4 ashramas, Gotra system, child marriage started, women status declined, Sati traces वर्ण जन्म आधारित कठोर, 4 आश्रम, गोत्र प्रणाली, बाल विवाह शुरू, स्त्री स्थिति गिरी
Pottery / मृदभांड	Ochre Coloured Pottery OCP	Painted Grey Ware PGW + Black & Red ware – associated with iron

Aspect / पहलू	Rigvedic 1500-1000 BCE	Later Vedic 1000-600 BCE
Metal / धातु	Ayas = Copper/Bronze (Shyama-ayas?)	Krishna-ayas = Iron, first use 1000 BCE at Atranjikhhera UP
Religion / धर्म	Nature worship, Indra 250 hymns main god, Agni 200, Varuna, Soma - Yajna simple	Prajapati supreme, Vishnu Rudra important, yajna complex, 16 priests, dominance of Brahmanas

4. चार वेद / Four Vedas - Detail (UPSC Heart)



1. Rigveda / ऋग्वेद - Oldest

Oldest Veda, 1500-1000 BCE. 1028 hymns (Suktas) + 11 Valakhilya = 1028-1042, 10 Mandalas, 10,552 mantras. Mandala 2-7 oldest (family mandalas), Mandala 1 & 10 newest. Mandala 3 has Gayatri Mantra (by Vishwamitra), Mandala 10 has Purusha Sukta (4 Varnas), Nasadiya Sukta (creation). Rishikas: Lopamudra, Ghosha, Apala, Vishwavara. Upaveda: Ayurveda. Brahmanas: Aitareya & Kaushitaki. Recited by Hotri priest.

PYQ: How many mandalas? 10 - SSC 2023

सबसे प्राचीन वेद, 1028 सूक्त + 11 वालखिल्य, 10 मंडल, 10,552 मंत्र। मंडल 2-7 प्राचीन (परिवार मंडल), 1 व 10 नवीन। मंडल 3 में गायत्री मंत्र (विश्वामित्र), मंडल 10 में पुरुष सूक्त (4 वर्ण), नासदीय सूक्त। उपवेद आयुर्वेद। ब्राह्मण ऐतरेय, कौषीतकी। होता द्वारा पाठ।

2. Samaveda / सामवेद - Music

Book of Melodies. 1549 mantras (except 75 rest from Rigveda 8th & 9th mandala). Called 'Book of Chants'. Origin of Indian Music. 2 parts: Purvarchika & Uttararchika. Upaveda: Gandharvaveda (music). Priest: Udgatri. Samaveda has 7 swaras - origin of Sargam Sa Re Ga Ma.

PYQ: Which Veda is source of music? Samaveda - SSC 2022

गान का वेद। 1549 मंत्र (75 को छोड़कर सभी ऋग्वेद से)। भारतीय संगीत का जनक। 7 स्वर - सा रे गा मा की उत्पत्ति। उपवेद गंधर्ववेद। उद्गाता द्वारा गायन।

3. Yajurveda / यजुर्वेद - Rituals

Book of Sacrificial Formulas. Prose + Verse. 2 types: Shukla (White) Yajurveda - Vajasaneyi Samhita by Yajnavalkya (40 chapters, includes Isha Upanishad) & Krishna (Black) Yajurveda - mixed prose verse - Taittiriya, Maitrayani, Kathaka,

Kapishthala Samhitas. Upaveda: Dhanurveda (archery). Priest: Adhvaryu. Describes Yajnas.

यज्ञ सूत्रों का वेद। गद्य + पद्य। 2 प्रकार: शुक्ल यजुर्वेद - वाजसनेयी संहिता (याज्ञवल्क्य, 40 अध्याय, ईशोपनिषद् शामिल) और कृष्ण यजुर्वेद - तैत्तिरीय, मैत्रायणी आदि। उपवेद धनुर्वेद। अध्वर्यु द्वारा प्रयोग।

4. Atharvaveda / अथर्ववेद - Magic & Daily Life

Book of Magic & Spells. 20 Kandas, 731 Suktas, 5987 Mantras. Composed by Atharva & Angiras rishis. Deals with daily life, diseases, cure, black magic, white magic, Ayurveda origin. Not included in Trayi (Rig Sama Yajur). Upaveda:

Shilpaveda/Sthapatyaveda (architecture). Considered Vratya Veda. Latest Veda.

PYQ: Which Veda deals with magic? Atharvaveda - SSC CGL 2021

जादू-टोना व दैनिक जीवन का वेद। 20 कांड, 731 सूक्त, 5987 मंत्र। अथर्व व अंगिरस ऋषि। आयुर्वेद, औषधि, तंत्र-मंत्र। त्रयी में नहीं गिना जाता। सबसे नवीन वेद। उपवेद शिल्पवेद।

5. उपवेद / Upavedas - 4 Auxiliary Vedas

Ayurveda

Upaveda of Rigveda

Medicine / आयुर्वेद - Charaka Sushruta

चिकित्सा

Gandharvaveda

Upaveda of Samaveda

Music & Dance / संगीत

भरत मुनि नाट्यशास्त्र

Dhanurveda

Upaveda of Yajurveda

Archery & Warfare / धनुर्वेद

युद्ध कला

Shilpaveda / Sthapatyaveda

Upaveda of Atharvaveda

Architecture / शिल्पवेद

वास्तुकला

6. वेदांग / 6 Vedangas - Limbs of Vedas (To understand Vedas)

वेदों को समझने के लिए 6 अंग - सूत्र शैली में

1. Shiksha / शिक्षा - Phonetics - उच्चारण - Panini - Ear of Vedas / वेदों के नाक

2. Kalpa / कल्प – Rituals – कर्मकांड – Sutras: Shrouta, Grihya, Dharma, Shulba – Hand of Vedas / हाथ

3. Vyakarana / व्याकरण – Grammar – Panini Ashtadhyayi – Mouth of Vedas / मुख

4. Nirukta / निरुक्त – Etymology – Yaska – Nighantu – Tongue / जीभ – शब्दों की व्युत्पत्ति

5. Chhanda / छंद – Metrics – Pingala – Feet / पैर – Gayatri 24, Anushtubh 32, Trishtubh 44

6. Jyotisha / ज्योतिष – Astronomy – Lagadha – Eye / आँख – वेदांग ज्योतिष

Trick: S K V N C J = Siksha Kalpa Vyakaran Nirukta Chhanda Jyotisha – UPSC PYQ 2020 asked number of Vedangas = 6

7. ब्राह्मण, आरण्यक, उपनिषद / Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads

Brahmanas / ब्राह्मण ग्रंथ

Prose explanation of Vedas, rituals, yajnas. Each Veda has Brahmanas:

Rigveda: Aitareya (8 Panchikas, 40 Adhyayas – first mention of kingship origin), Kaushitaki

Samaveda: Panchavimsha (Tandya), Shadvimsha, Jaiminiya

Yajurveda: Shatapatha (Most important – 100 chapters, longest – describes 32 types of Shulba, origin of Kurus, story of Manu flood, Gandhara to Videha migration)

Atharvaveda: Gopatha

वेदों की गद्य व्याख्या, यज्ञ कर्मकांड।

शतपथ ब्राह्मण सबसे महत्वपूर्ण – 100 अध्याय, सबसे बड़ा – मनु की बाढ़ कथा, कुरु वंश उत्पत्ति, गांधार से विदेह प्रवास।

Aranyakas / आरण्यक

Forest texts – transition between Brahmana (ritual) & Upanishad (philosophy). For Vanaprastha (forest dwellers). Deal with mystic meaning of rituals, not Karma but Jnana. 7 Aranyakas: Aitareya, Kaushitaki, Taittiriya, Katha, Brihadaranyaka etc. Called 'Philosophy of Sacrifice'.

वन में पढ़े जाने वाले ग्रंथ – ब्राह्मण (कर्मकांड) और उपनिषद (ज्ञान) के बीच का सेतु। वानप्रस्थियों के लिए। यज्ञों का रहस्यमय अर्थ। 'यज्ञों का दर्शन'।

Upanishads / उपनिषद – Vedanta

108 Upanishads but 13 Principal (Mukhya). End of Vedas – Vedanta. Philosophy of Atman (soul), Brahman (ultimate reality), Moksha, Karma, Maya. Guru-Shishya

dialogue.

Important: Brihadaranyaka (largest, Yajnavalkya-Maitreyi dialogue), Chandogya (Tat Tvam Asi – That Thou Art), Kena, Katha (Nachiketa-Yama), Isha (in Shukla Yajurveda), Mundaka (Satyameva Jayate), Mandukya (Om), Shvetashvatara, Taittiriya etc.

Motto: Satyameva Jayate from Mundaka Upanishad.

Schopenhauer: Upanishads solace of my life.

108 उपनिषद्, 13 मुख्य। वेदांत - वेदों का अंत। आत्मा, ब्रह्म, मोक्ष, कर्म का दर्शन। बृहदारण्यक सबसे बड़ा, छंदोग्य में तत् त्वम् असि, मुंडक में सत्यमेव जयते।

8. समाज, राजनीति, अर्थ, धर्म / Society, Polity, Economy, Religion

Society / समाज

Rigvedic: Patriarchal, joint family, no child marriage, Swayamvara, women rishikas
Lopamudra Ghosha Apala, no Sati Purdah. Later: Gotra exogamy, 4 ashramas (Brahmacharya Grihastha Vanaprastha Sanyasa), Varna rigid birth based, child marriage started, women status declined but still Gargi Maitreyi in Upanishads.

Polity / राजनीति

Rigvedic: Tribe Jana, chief Rajan, Sabha Samiti Vidatha, Gana, no standing army, Bali voluntary tax, no land ownership, battle for cattle (Gavishthi). Later: Janapada, king Samrat, Sabha Samiti still, king's power ↑, 12 Ratnins, bureaucracy, land ownership private, taxation Bhaga 1/6.

Economy / अर्थव्यवस्था

Rigvedic: Pastoral, cattle Gomat wealth, Yava barley, no coins barter (Nishka). Later: Agriculture wheat rice barley, iron plough at Atranjikhara 1000 BCE, 24 oxen plough (24 oxen team in Shatapatha), crafts, Nishka Shatamana coins, sea trade? Mention of Samudra.

Religion / धर्म + Gods

Rigvedic: 33 gods (Traya Trayastrimsha), Nature worship, Indra 250 hymns rain war god (Purandara), Agni 200 mediator, Varuna moral, Soma plant god, Gayatri to Savitri. Later: Prajapati supreme, Vishnu Rudra Shiv important, 16 priests, complex yajnas - Rajasuya (royal consecration), Ashvamedha (horse sacrifice for empire), Vajapeya (chariot race).

★ 40 Key Facts – UPSC/SSC/PSC Rattafication

1. Rigveda oldest, 10 Mandalas, 1028 Suktas, 10,552 Mantras
2. Mandala 2–7 family mandalas oldest, 1 & 10 newest
3. Gayatri Mantra in Mandala 3 by Vishwamitra to Savitri
4. Purusha Sukta in Mandala 10 – 4 Varnas mention – UPSC asked
5. Samaveda = Music – 1549 mantras, Udgatri priest
6. Yajurveda = Rituals – Shukla White Vajasaneyi 40 chap, Krishna Black Taittiriya – Adhvaryu
7. Atharvaveda = Magic daily life – 20 Kandas 731 Suktas – latest
8. Upavedas: Ayurveda Rig, Gandharvaveda Sama, Dhanurveda Yajur, Shilpaveda Atharva
9. 6 Vedangas: Shiksha Kalpa Vyakaran Nirukta Chhanda Jyotisha – 6 limbs
10. Brahmanas prose ritual – Shatapatha largest 100 chapters – describes Gandhara to Videha migration
11. Aranyakas = Forest texts, bridge between Brahmana & Upanishad
12. 108 Upanishads, 13 Mukhya, Vedanta, Satyameva Jayate from Mundaka
13. Tat Tvam Asi from Chandogya Upanishad – That Thou Art
14. Battle of Ten Kings Dasarajna on Parushni Ravi – Sudas Bharata won – Bharat name
15. Sapta Sindhu: Sindhu Vitasta Asikni Parushni Vipasa Shutudri Saraswati
16. Early Vedic OCP, Later Vedic PGW + iron at Atranjikhhera 1000 BCE
17. Sabha Samiti Vidatha – Vidatha oldest, disappeared in Later Vedic
18. Bali voluntary tax Rigvedic, Bhaga 1/6 Later Vedic
19. 4 Ashramas system in Later Vedic – Brahmacharya Grihastha Vanaprastha Sanyasa
20. Gotra system started Later Vedic – exogamy
21. Women rishikas Lopamudra Ghosha Apala Vishwavara – Rigvedic, Gargi Maitreyi – Later
22. Iron called Krishna-ayas, Copper Shyama-ayas
23. Indra 250 hymns most, Agni 200 second
24. Rajasuya Ashvamedha Vajapeya yajnas in Later Vedic – 16 priests
25. Nishka gold ornament + coin Rigvedic, Shatamana Later

45 PYQs – SSC/UPSC/PSC

- Q1. Oldest Veda? (SSC CGL 2022, UPSC) → **Rigveda**
- Q2. How many Mandalas in Rigveda? (SSC CHSL 2023) → **10**
- Q3. Gayatri Mantra in which Mandala? (UPSC 2019, SSC) → **3rd by Vishwamitra**
- Q4. Purusha Sukta Varna mention in? (UPSC 2020) → **10th Mandala Rigveda**

- Q5. Music origin Veda?** (SSC 2022) → **Samaveda**
- Q6. Magic & daily life Veda?** (SSC CGL 2021) → **Atharvaveda**
- Q7. Upaveda of Rigveda?** (SSC) → **Ayurveda**
- Q8. Upaveda of Samaveda?** → **Gandharvaveda**
- Q9. Dhanurveda upaveda of?** → **Yajurveda**
- Q10. How many Vedangas?** (UPSC 2020) → **6**
- Q11. Vedangas are?** → **Shiksha Kalpa Vyakaran Nirukta Chhanda Jyotisha**
- Q12. Largest Brahmana?** (UPSC) → **Shatapatha 100 chapters**
- Q13. Vedanta called?** → **Upanishads**
- Q14. Satyameva Jayate from?** (SSC CGL 2020) → **Mundaka Upanishad**
- Q15. Tat Tvam Asi from?** (UPSC) → **Chandogya Upanishad**
- Q16. Battle of Ten Kings river?** → **Parushni (Ravi)**
- Q17. Early Vedic pottery?** → **OCF Ochre Coloured**
- Q18. Later Vedic pottery?** → **PGW Painted Grey Ware**
- Q19. Iron first at?** (SSC) → **Atranjikhhera UP 1000 BCE**
- Q20. Most imp god Rigvedic?** → **Indra 250 hymns**
- Q21. Rishikas in Rigveda?** → **Lopamudra Ghosha Apala**
- Q22. Sabha Samiti Vidatha oldest?** → **Vidatha**
- Q23. 4 Ashramas in?** → **Later Vedic**
- Q24. Gotra system started?** → **Later Vedic**
- Q25. Gayatri is metre of how many letters?** → **24 letters**
- Q26. Upanishads number?** → **108, 13 Mukhya**
- Q27. Isha Upanishad part of?** → **Shukla Yajurveda 40th chapter**
- Q28. Largest Upanishad?** → **Brihadaranyaka**
- Q29. Samaveda priest?** → **Udgatri**
- Q30. Rigveda priest?** → **Hotri**
- Q31. Yajurveda priest?** → **Adhvaryu**
- Q32. Atharvaveda priest?** → **Brahma**
- Q33. Bali tax?** → **Voluntary Rigvedic**
- Q34. Bhaga tax?** → **1/6 Later Vedic**
- Q35. Nishka?** → **Gold ornament + coin**

Thank You!

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Rigvedic & Later Vedic + Complete Vedic Literature | Updated July 2026 |

UPSC/SSC/PSC

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